



<http://www.esmr.org/>

Minutes of the General Assembly of the European Society for Muscle Research held on the 21st of September 2025 at the 52nd European Muscle Conference (EMC) in Amsterdam, The Netherlands.

§1 The chair of the European Society for Muscle Research (ESMR), **Dr. Wolfgang Linke**, welcomed the Assembly to the membership meeting, introduced the agenda (with approval from the Assembly), and explained the nature of the ESMR as well as its relationship to the EMC. He expressed gratitude to Drs. Josine de Winter, Diederik Kuster and Coen Ottenheijm and their team for organizing a very successful EMC in Amsterdam.

§2 Dr. Linke proposed **Dr. Elisabeth Ehler** (London) to be appointed to take the minutes of the General Assembly. **Dr. Alain Lacampagne** (Montpellier) was appointed as the accountant on the minutes.

This was **agreed** by the Assembly.

§3 The current members of the Board of the Society were presented:

Wolfgang Linke, *Chair*, University of Münster, Germany (re-elected 2022)

Anders Arner, *Treasurer*, Lund University, Sweden (re-elected 2022)

Kristina Djinoić-Carugo, University of Vienna, Austria & EMBL Grenoble, France (re-elected 2022)

Elisabeth Ehler, *Secretary*, King's College London, UK (re-elected 2022)

Chiara Tesi, Università degli Studi di Firenze, Florence, Italy (re-elected 2022)

Maria Jolanta Redowicz, Nencki Institute, Warsaw, Poland (re-elected 2023)

Coen Ottenheijm, Free University of Amsterdam, The Netherlands (re-elected 2023)

Alain Lacampagne, Inserm U1046 CNRS, Montpellier, France (elected 2023)

Josine de Winter, Free University of Amsterdam, The Netherlands (elected 2023)

§4 The minutes of the previous EMC meeting in Ljubljana 2024 (accountants: **Chiara Tesi**, Florence; **Josine de Winter**, Amsterdam) have been available at the Society homepage (www.esmr.org).

No further comments were made and the minutes **were approved**.

§5 Wolfgang Linke reported on the activities of the board.

Anders Arner reported (Sep-19-2025) on the economy of the ESMR, until recently registered as a charitable organization (“ideell förening”) in Sweden since 2012. In this organization form, ESMR were allowed to have a bank account to keep the funds, receive membership fees, and interest without tax. Society funds were deposited at Skandinaviska Enskilda Banken (SEB) in one low interest account with faster access and one account with 3 months access and fixed interest rate (though still quite low). The funds were kept in Swedish krona (100 SEK ~ 9 EUR).

At the end of the last fiscal year (Sep 2024), ESMR funds were 417,096.44 SEK (~34,254 EUR). The Society paid for banking service (50 SEK/Month) and received the 10 EUR per paying participant from the previous EMC in Ljubljana in 2024 (1,990 EUR). The tax declaration for 2023 was approved and there was no tax to pay. A new tax declaration for 2024 was submitted in July 2025.

As agreed by the Society Membership, a notary was contacted by **Coen Ottenheijm** and **Josine de Winter** and, following written approval by all ESMR Board members, **the Society was registered in The Netherlands in 2025**. A service fee was paid to the notary (12,910.77 SEK = 1,153.28 EUR). The Society funds from the two bank accounts in Sweden (437,142.57 SEK = 39,667.57 EUR) were then transferred to The Netherlands, where ESMR now has an account with the ING bank—opened by Coen Ottenheijm and Josine de Winter on behalf of the Society. The remaining accounts in Sweden are zero and this will enable the Society to be terminated in Sweden. Thus, the **total funds currently are 39,667 EUR** in the Society account in The Netherlands (ING).

The auditors **Miklos Kellermayer** (Hungary) and **Martina Krüger** (Germany) received copies of the bank status report and the economic report. The auditors approved the economic report.

On request, the Assembly **granted discharge of liability** for the ESMR Board members.

The **annual membership fee was decided to be 10 EUR/year**, paid by meeting delegates as a part of the registration fee. The Assembly **approved this proposal**.

§6 Election of the Auditors

Dr. Jolanda van der Velden (Netherlands) and **Dr. Jorge Alegre-Cebollada** (Spain) were proposed as the auditor and deputy auditor for 2025/26 and were approved by the membership.

In 2025, no elections or re-elections of ESMR board members were held. The regular interval of service on the board is **4 years**, with the possibility of re-election.

ESMR chair Wolfgang Linke commented that the society's policy is to usually have one representative, occasionally two representatives, from the same country on the stirring board. Because the Society will be permanently registered and has a bank account in The Netherlands, two representatives from The Netherlands are members of the board.

§7. **Dr. Elisabeth Ehler** reported on the activities and standing of the Journal of Muscle Research and Cell Motility, a long-term professional ally of ESMR. A **Special Issue of EMC 2025** was announced, and scientists were invited to submit papers.

§8. Young Muscle Researchers

Dr. Franziska Koser (Univ. of Münster, Germany) reported on the activities of the **Early Careers Association (ESMR-ECA)**, founded in 2022. The young muscle researchers of ESMR-ECA have developed their own scientific and socializing activities during EMC (including @Amsterdam 2025) and plan to hold webinar events throughout

the year. They also acquired Travel Award money for EMC 2025 and plan to do so for EMC 2026. ESMR-ECA is also represented on the Society homepage accessible at <https://esmr.org/early-careers.html>.

- Invitation to join the ESMR-ECA:



<https://forms.gle/fyCgzXh3N1vjZ6hX9>

The ESMR-ECA is active on the following social media channels, and invites **all ESMR scientists** to join:



- **Bluesky**
European Society for
Muscle Research Early
Careers Association
@esmreca.bsky.social



- **LinkedIn**
European Society for Muscle
Research
Early Careers Association
(ESMR-ECA)

§9. Other issues

None raised

§10. The plans for the Annual ESMR Meeting 2026 to take place in **Vienna**, Austria September 06-09, were presented by **Dr. Kristina Djinovic-Carugo**.

Future plans for EMC events include 2027 Hannover and 2028 Montpellier.

The Assembly was closed.

Dr. Elisabeth Ehler (London)

Date: 15 June 2026

Dr. Alain Lacampagne (Montpellier)

Date: 17/06/2026